

Restricted Reporting for Copilot Analytics in a Multi-Agency Single Tenant

Version: 2.2 | Author: Sumit Sadhu | Last validated: 19 August 2026

THIS GUIDE’S AUTHOR-CREATED ARCHITECTURE PATTERN

Restricted Reporting is an editorial name created by this guide. Earlier versions called it “Isolation”; that word remains in the filename and URL only to avoid breaking links. Restricted Reporting and **Default Priority** are not Microsoft product, security, compliance, sovereignty, or licensing terms. Microsoft documents the component capabilities, but does not document this combination as an end-to-end security boundary.

This pattern coordinates multiple controls to reduce cross-agency reporting paths. Viva Insights partitions limit the **rows and columns available in an assigned analyst query workspace**. Partitions do not govern Copilot Dashboard, Analytics Reports, Agent Dashboard, metrics export, delegation, manager access, privileged/global access, downloaded query results, or Power BI. Group-scoped Viva feature access management (VFAM), access lists, role/partition governance, and Power BI controls are separate layers. The outcome is **defense in depth and reporting segmentation**, not cryptographic, tenant, product-security, sovereign, or independently certified isolation.

Surface-by-Actor Boundary Matrix

Actor / surface	Primary control
Agency leader or manager — Copilot Dashboard / Analytics Reports	Access list, hierarchy-derived scope, AutoCxO,
Delegate — Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, and Copilot insights	Delegation eligibility, delegator scope, and dele
Agency analyst — advanced query workspace	Insights Analyst role plus one agency partition
Global Administrator, globally assigned user, or global-partition analyst	Least-privilege assignment, expiry, audit, and re
Leader or analyst — Agent Dashboard / metrics export	Separate product eligibility and feature/access
Power BI Viewer, Member, Contributor, or app audience	Dedicated workspace/app, Viewer-first roles, s

Residual Risks That Require Explicit Acceptance

- Shared executives and cross-agency managers can have hierarchy scopes that cross agency boundaries.

- Global Administrators, globally assigned users, global-partition analysts, and approved Central IT roles retain broader access by design.
- One analyst assigned to multiple agencies can create a conflict of interest even when each query is partition-scoped.
- Incorrect, stale, missing, or overlapping **Agency** / **Domain** values can place people in the wrong query population or no population.
- Preview behavior, tenant rollout, service incidents, policy precedence, and product changes can invalidate a previously passing result.
- Power BI sharing, export, Build, Analyze in Excel, subscriptions, and copied files can disclose report data independently of Viva Insights.

Supported-environment and licensing gate:

Supported Microsoft 365 environments for Viva Insights features (last updated 30 June 2026) says GCC does not support Agent Dashboard, Copilot metrics export, or Copilot Power BI reports. Connect to the Agent Dashboard (30 July 2026) says Agent Dashboard is unavailable in national and regional clouds. Plan-level support does not establish feature parity. Validate the exact cloud, tenant UI, Message Center, assigned service plans, agent activity, and each required surface before design. API-based organizational-data import is preview and current environment support must also be checked.

Microsoft pages describe the advanced-access threshold differently. Environment requirements for Viva Insights (12 May 2026) explicitly gives **30 Microsoft 365 Copilot + 20 Viva Insights** as 50 assigned Viva Insights service plans; Connect to the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard for Microsoft 365 customers (18 August 2026) describes 50 Copilot or 50 Viva Insights. Do not state that mixed assignments fail. Verify assigned service plans and feature presence. For Agent Dashboard, use the conservative feature-specific prerequisite of **50 Microsoft Copilot licences plus agent activity**; a 50-Viva-Insights-only tenant must validate availability. Escalate a documented mismatch to Microsoft Support.

Organizational-data precedence gate:

Do not describe an upload as universally or permanently replacing Entra. Uploaded values change the source for supplied dashboard attributes; parallel ingestion can keep or restore Entra for **ManagerId** and **Organization** ; Microsoft 365 Profile precedence is separate. Before change, capture each required attribute, current source, owner, effective date, coverage, and target surface in Data Quality and Profile. Check **Setup → Migration and imports**, Message Center, and the actual tenant UI. Use Organizational Data in Microsoft 365 for new/edited uploads unless the tenant explicitly presents a supported legacy path. Use documented update/delete behavior, not dummy rows.

Mandatory Negative Tests, Evidence, and Release Veto

1. **Actors:** test an agency leader, cross-agency manager, shared executive, delegate, agency analyst, multi-partition analyst, global-partition analyst, Power BI Viewer, Power BI Member/Contributor, AI Administrator, Insights Administrator, Insights Analyst, and Global Administrator.
2. **Surfaces:** test Copilot Dashboard, Analytics Reports, Agent Dashboard, weekly/daily metrics export, advanced query workspace, query-result download, delegation, manager-published reports, Power BI workspace/app, report export, Analyze in Excel, subscriptions, and resharing.
3. **Evidence:** capture test date, tester identity/role, group and partition memberships, VFAM/access export, organizational-data source/quality snapshot, expected denial or allowed result, observed result, screenshot or audit record, Power BI permissions, owner, and remediation ticket.
4. **Publication and go-live veto:** any failed or unexecutable negative test blocks publication and production rollout. Restore the pre-change state or remove access, preserve evidence, and open Microsoft Support when documented and observed behavior differ.
5. **Approval and retest:** obtain written Security, Compliance/Legal, Privacy/DPO, Viva Insights owner, and Power BI owner sign-off on tested behavior and residual risks. Product documentation is not an attestation. Repeat the full suite quarterly and after any role, hierarchy, delegation, org-data, partition, VFAM, licence, cloud, preview-status, or sharing change.

Rollback and Change Control

Before change, export or capture VFAM policies, access lists, role assignments, delegations, manager hierarchy, partition filters and analysts, organizational-data source and quality, query assets, and Power BI workspace/app/RLS/export settings. Define the owner, maintenance window, approvers, success criteria, failure criteria, Support trigger, and restoration sequence. Use a representative test cohort first. Treat enabling partitions as a high-impact tenant change; Microsoft documents Support involvement to turn partitions off. Export query assets before enabling, and confirm current deletion impact before removing a partition. For organizational data, use supported update/delete behavior and restore the documented source configuration; never seed dummy rows.

Dated Microsoft Source Register

- Connect to the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard for Microsoft 365 customers — last updated 18 August 2026.
- Connect to the Agent Dashboard — 30 July 2026.
- Environment requirements for Viva Insights — 12 May 2026.
- Supported Microsoft 365 environments for Viva Insights features — 30 June 2026.
- Manage settings for the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, and Viva Insights web app — 13 August 2026.
- Roles in Viva Insights — 7 July 2026.
- Delegate access to the Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, and Copilot insights — 9 February 2026.

- Configure manager settings — 23 July 2026.
- Partitions in Viva Insights — 23 June 2025.
- Customize Viva Insights privacy settings — 20 November 2025.
- Technical privacy guide for organization insights and advanced analysis — 10 December 2025.
- Use your organizational data in Microsoft 365 and Microsoft Viva — 2 December 2025.
- Upload and maintain data through the Microsoft 365 admin center — 13 August 2026.
- Use Microsoft Entra plus .csv files for parallel data uploads — 30 June 2025.
- Import and manage your organizational data with a .csv file — 29 July 2026.
- Import organizational data from Workday — 6 April 2026; 100,000-user limit.
- Import organizational data using API-based import (preview) — 6 April 2026.

Broader authorized visibility is acceptable? Use the simpler **Default Priority pattern**. It uses native AutoCxo, delegation, and “Your group” as an expected starting view; manager hierarchy is not a security boundary.

TL;DR — Two Data Paths for Restricted Reporting

Both paths share the same group-scoped surface restrictions and release gate. Choose the partition attribute based on the supported organizational-data state:

	Path A: CSV Org Data Upload	Path B: Entra ID D
When to use	Agencies share one email domain, OR you need Department + Agency filtering	Each agency has
Partition filter	Agency = "Agency A"	Domain = "ager
Data upload needed?	Yes — CSV with Agency attribute	No — Domain is s
Extra filtering	Full: Department, Location, Job Function, etc.	Limited to Entra

Common Steps (both paths):

1. **Apply group-scoped restrictions** to direct agency access (VFAM + Entra group) — Phase 1
2. **Choose your data strategy** — CSV upload (Path A) or Entra Domain (Path B) — Section 4.1
3. **Create one partition per agency** in Viva Insights — Phase 3
4. **Assign agency-specific analysts** to their partitions only — Section 7
5. **Deliver reports** through separately governed Power BI workspaces/apps; permit manager publishing only after its full surface test — Phase 4

Time estimate: 1–3 days depending on path chosen.

Prerequisites & Licensing

Requirement	Details
Assigned service plans and tenant feature presence verified using the conflict-safe threshold wording above	Do not reject
Insights Admin + AI Admin roles assigned	Assign via M365
Security, Compliance/Legal, Privacy/DPO, Viva Insights, and Power BI sign-off	Written appr
Minimum group size agreed by all agencies	Tenant-wide
Supported environment and previews validated	Record clou

Potential extra costs (evaluate before Phase 4):

- **Power BI Pro/PPU:** Required per viewer if delivering reports via PBI workspaces. Alternative: **Power BI Premium capacity** (P or F SKU) allows free-licence viewers.
- **Viva Insights standalone:** Required for agency heads who need Publish Reports access but do **not** have a Copilot licence (Copilot licence includes Viva Insights automatically).

How to Use This Document

Read Section 4.1 to choose your data path (A or B). Then follow Section 5 phases 0–4 sequentially. Refer to §7–§9 for ongoing governance. If you need to assess your environment first, start with the Discovery Questions in Section 10.

1. Executive Summary

This document provides an author-created, defense-in-depth reporting pattern for Microsoft Copilot Dashboard and Copilot Analytics in a **single Microsoft 365 tenant** that hosts **multiple agencies**. It coordinates product controls to reduce cross-agency reporting paths; it does not establish an end-to-end security boundary.

Core Constraint & Key Finding:

The design objective is to prevent routine agency-facing reporting paths from exposing another agency’s data. The Copilot Dashboard and other tenant surfaces are governed separately from analyst partitions, and some access sources can remain tenant-wide. Therefore the objective must be expressed and tested per actor and surface rather than as an absolute guarantee.

Recommended Approach: Two Coordinated Reporting Layers

- 1. **Viva Insights Advanced Analytics with Partitions** — for row/column-scoped agency analyst query workspaces.
- 2. **Copilot Dashboard with controlled access** — for tenant-level oversight by central IT only (secondary, restricted use).
- 3. **Power BI workspaces/apps** — a separate agency-facing delivery layer with Viewer-first permissions, sharing/export controls, and optional RLS.

2. Business Context & Requirements

2.1 Organizational Structure



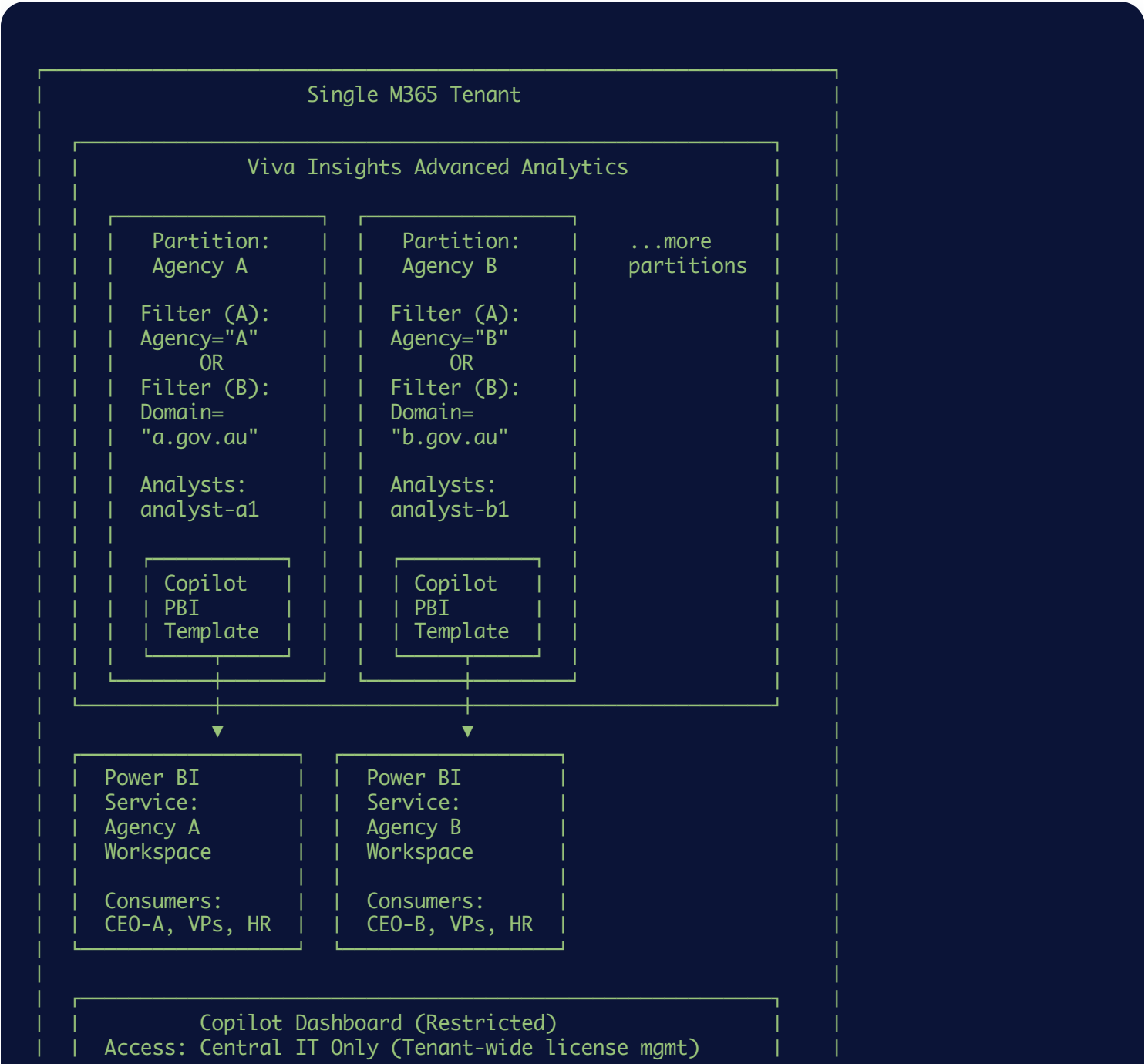
2.2 Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-01	Agency-facing reports are limited to the approved agency population on every tested delivery path	P0 – Mission Critical
FR-02	Unapproved cross-agency access attempts fail in the mandatory actor/surface test matrix	P0 – Mission Critical
FR-03	Each agency CEO gets adoption, impact, and sentiment metrics	P1 – Strategic
FR-04	Central IT retains tenant-wide visibility for license management	P1 – Strategic
FR-05	Agency-level analysts can run custom Copilot queries	P2 – Nice to Have

3. Solution Options Assessment

Option	Description	FR-01 (Agency
1. Dashboard Only	Standard deployment relying on "Your group" scope.	✗ Fail
2. Dashboard + Delegation	Admin delegates "Your group" view to CEOs.	✗ Fail
3. Partitions (Advanced Analytics)	Create Viva Insights Partitions per agency.	✓ Pass
4. Hybrid (Partitions + Restricted Dashboard)	Partitions for agencies + Dashboard for Central IT.	✓ Pass

4. Recommended Architecture



4.1 Choose Your Path: CSV Org Data vs. Entra ID Domain

Viva Insights partitions filter on **organizational data attributes**. Attributes reach Viva Insights from two sources:

Source	Attributes Available
Microsoft Entra ID (automatic sync)	<code>PersonId</code> , <code>ManagerId</code> , <code>Organization</code> (from Entra <code>Department</code> field), plus s
CSV Org Data Upload	All of the above, plus up to 105 custom attributes: <code>Agency</code> , <code>FunctionType</code> , Lo

Path A: CSV Org Data Upload (Full Capability)

Use when:

- All agencies share the **same email domain** (e.g., everyone is `@onetenant.gov.au`)
- You need both agency analyst query segmentation and department/location/job-function filtering
- You want the richest possible analytics (custom attributes, before/after cohort segmentation)
- HR can provide a consolidated employee CSV with an `Agency` column

Partition filter: `Agency = "Agency A"`

End-to-end workflow:

1. Phase 0: Pre-flight audit (same as Path B)
2. Phase 1: Lockdown — disable AutoCxO, delegation, Agent Dashboard, Metrics Export (same as Path B)
3. **Phase 2: Prepare and upload CSV** with `PersonId` , `ManagerId` , `Organization` , `EffectiveDate` , and custom `Agency` attribute. Verify 100% coverage on Data Quality page.
4. Phase 3: Create partitions filtered by `Agency = "Agency A"` , etc. Assign analysts.
5. Phase 4: Analysts run Copilot PBI queries within their partition → publish reports.

Time estimate: 2–3 days. **Ongoing:** Monthly CSV re-upload to keep data current.

Path B: Entra ID Domain Filter (Zero CSV)

Use when:

- Each agency has a **distinct email domain** (e.g., `agencya.gov.au` , `agencyb.gov.au`)
- All employees use their agency domain as their **primary SMTP address**

- You **do not** need custom attribute filtering (Department/Location come only from Entra defaults)
- You want the **fastest possible deployment** with zero data preparation

Partition filter: `Domain = "agencya.gov.au"`

End-to-end workflow:

1. Phase 0: Pre-flight audit (same as Path A)
2. Phase 1: Lockdown — disable AutoCxO, delegation, Agent Dashboard, Metrics Export (same as Path A)
3. **Phase 2: Skip CSV upload.** Optionally enable `ManagerId` and `Organization` in “Configure Entra connection” for richer hierarchy and department data.
4. Phase 3: Create partitions filtered by `Domain = "agencya.gov.au"`, etc. Assign analysts.
5. Phase 4: Analysts run Copilot PBI queries within their partition → publish reports.

Time estimate: 1 day (no CSV preparation for the partition filter). **Ongoing:** Monitor primary SMTP domains, transfers, exceptions, contractors, and shared-service identities; verify partition counts after changes.

Decision Matrix

Question	If Yes → Path
Do all agencies share the same email domain?	Path A (CSV required — <code>Domain</code> cannot differ)
Does each agency have a unique email domain?	Path B is available (can also use Path A for richer data)
Do you need Department/Location/Job Function filters per agency?	Path A (CSV adds these attributes beyond Entra defaults)
Are there shared-services staff on a common domain?	Path A preferred (assign <code>Agency = "Shared Services"</code>)
Need the fastest deployment with minimal data preparation?	Path B (zero CSV, Domain-only filter)
Want to start with Path B and add CSV later?	Path B now, Path A later — you can always upload CSV later

Important: Whichever path you choose, the **group-scoped surface restrictions**, partition assignment governance, Power BI controls, and evidence gate are the same. The path changes how organizational data reaches Viva Insights and which attribute scopes the analyst query workspace.

4.2 Entra ID Attributes Reference for Viva Insights

Understanding exactly which Entra ID attributes reach Viva Insights is critical for choosing the right path. Per Microsoft Learn:

Already know your path? If you have already decided between Path A and Path B in Section 4.1, you can skip this reference section and go directly to the Implementation Runbook (Section 5).

Attributes Synced from Entra ID

Entra ID Source Field	Viva Insights Attribute	Available for Partition Filter?	Notes
UserPrincipalName	PersonId	No (identifier only)	Always synced
Manager / UserPrincipalName	ManagerId	Yes (required attribute)	Enable via "Configure Entra c
Department	Organization	Yes (required attribute)	Enable via "Configure Entra c

System-Generated Attributes (Always Available)

Attribute	Source	Available for Partition Filter?	Multi-Agency Use
Domain	Primary SMTP address	Yes	Key attribute for Path B — if each agenc
TimeZone	Outlook/Exchange settings	Yes	Useful for geography analysis; do not tree
PopulationType	SMTP address	Yes	Distinguishes internal vs. external collabo

Attributes NOT Available from Entra ID

The following Entra ID user profile fields are **not** synced to Viva Insights. If you need them, you must upload via CSV:

On-Premises Active Directory Pipeline: Do not assume custom on-premises or Entra extension attributes flow through the Viva Entra connector. Verify the actual available attributes in Data Quality/Profile. Supply required custom attributes through a currently supported organizational-data import path, which may be CSV, a supported HR connector, or API-based import preview depending on cloud and tenant state.

Entra ID Field	Status in Viva Insights
Company	Not synced — use CSV Organization or custom attribute
Division	Not synced
JobTitle	Not synced — use CSV FunctionType
City / Country / State	Not synced — use CSV Location / CountryOrRegion
EmployeeType	Not synced
extensionAttribute1-15	Not synced

Common Misconception: Do not assume Company, Division, or extension attributes automatically appear in Viva Insights. Confirm connector output and attribute precedence in Data Quality/Profile; supply missing attributes through the supported tenant import path rather than assuming CSV is the only option.

Parallel Data Ingestion (Best of Both Worlds)

You can use **both** Entra ID and CSV simultaneously via the parallel data ingestion feature:

- Let Entra continue providing ManagerId and Organization (always accurate, auto-refreshing)
- Supply **only** the additional attributes you need (for example, Agency, Location, CostCentre) through the currently supported import path
- Entra-sourced attributes take precedence for the fields you select; CSV provides the rest

This is ideal for organisations starting with **Path B** (Domain-based) who later want to add richer attributes without disrupting existing Entra-based data flows.

5. Implementation Runbook

0 Phase O: Pre-Flight Audit

Before locking anything down, audit the current state and obtain approvals. Disabling policies does not revoke existing access.

Pre-flight approvals (complete before proceeding):

1. Obtain written **Security, Compliance/Legal, Privacy/DPO, Viva Insights, and Power BI owner** approval of the control design, test plan, accepted global access, residual risks, rollback, and evidence requirements. Do not ask reviewers to attest that partitions alone satisfy a regulation.
2. Confirm **all agency heads and compliance officers agree** on the minimum group size threshold (see Phase 3). Document the agreed number.
3. Confirm **role assignments** are in place: AI Admin and Insights Admin roles assigned to Central IT staff via M365 Microsoft 365 admin center → Settings → Microsoft Viva → Viva Insights → Add-on Plan, or via Role assignments → search role name. (Learn reference)

- **Audit VFAM policies (Admin UI):** Navigate to `admin.microsoft.com` → Settings → Microsoft Viva → Viva Insights → Set up and management → **Turn Advanced Insights on or off**. Review the status of each feature: AutoCxoldentification, CopilotDashboardDelegation, AgentDashboard, CopilotMetricsReport. Document the current state (On/Off, scope: Everyone or Specific users).
- **Alternative (PowerShell):** Run `Get-VivaModuleFeaturePolicy -ModuleId VivaInsights` for a scripted audit of all policies.
- **Audit dashboard access list:** Microsoft 365 admin center → Settings → Microsoft Viva → Viva Insights → **Manage access settings for Microsoft Copilot Dashboard**. Check who currently has access.
- Identify any agency CEOs or leaders who already have dashboard access (auto-enabled or manually added).
- Verify the Entra ID ManagerID hierarchy — confirm each agency CEO reports to a different top-level node (not to each other).

1 Phase 1: Group-Scoped Surface Restrictions

Reduce direct agency-user access to tenant-level Viva Insights surfaces. Complete each sub-step in order and verify effective access after propagation. This layer does not alter global, analyst-query, downloaded-result, or Power BI permissions. **Requires AI Administrator role.**

Group-Scoped Policies — Protect Non-Agency Leaders

VFAM policies set to “Everyone” affect the **entire tenant** — including non-agency executives (CFO, CISO, CIO) who may legitimately need dashboard access. To avoid this, create an Entra security group called **AgencyUsers-NoDashboard** containing all agency employees. Target your disable policies at **this group** instead of Everyone. This preserves access for Central IT, Finance, and other non-agency stakeholders. *All steps below use group-scoped targeting. See Appendix A for the full PowerShell reference.*

1.1 — Disable Auto CxO Identification

Microsoft 365 admin center → Settings → Microsoft Viva → Viva Insights → Turn Advanced Insights on or off → select **Auto CxO Identification** → Add policy → scope to **AgencyUsers-NoDashboard** → set to **Off** → Save.

1.2 — Remove existing auto-enabled agency leaders

Microsoft 365 admin center → Settings → Microsoft Viva → Viva Insights → **Manage access settings for Microsoft Copilot Dashboard** → remove any agency leaders who were auto-identified. Leave non-agency executives (CFO, CISO, etc.) in place if they need tenant-wide access.

1.3 — Disable Dashboard Delegation for agency users

Same “Turn Advanced Insights on or off” page → select **Copilot Dashboard Delegation** → Add policy → scope to **AgencyUsers-NoDashboard** → set to **Off** → Save.

1.4 — Restrict dashboard access to Central IT

Create Entra group **CentralIT-CopilotDashboard-Access**. In **Manage access settings for Microsoft Copilot Dashboard** → add this group → remove all individual agency users.

Supported group types for dashboard access: Entra security groups, Microsoft 365 groups, and mail-enabled security groups. Distribution-only groups are **not supported**. All group members must have a Viva Insights service plan (included with Copilot licence). Changes take up to **24 hours** to propagate. If group-based access does not work as expected, verify: (a) all members are licensed, (b) the group type is correct, (c) 24 hours have elapsed since assignment.

1.5 — Disable Agent Dashboard for agency users

Agent Dashboard is preview, unavailable in national/regional clouds, and uses a conservative prerequisite of 50 Microsoft Copilot licences plus agent activity. Where the surface exists, select **Agent Dashboard** → Add policy → scope to `AgencyUsers-NoDashboard` → set to **Off** → Save. Re-enable for a Central IT group only after privacy review and a separate tenant-wide access test.

1.6 — Disable Copilot Metrics Export (PowerShell only)

Copilot metrics export is preview, is not partition-scoped, and is unavailable in GCC. Disable it for the agency-user group and test weekly/daily export denial. This feature does not have an Admin UI toggle. Use PowerShell:

```
Add-VivaModuleFeaturePolicy -ModuleId VivaInsights -FeatureId CopilotMetricsReport -Name "DisableMetricsExport" -IsFeatureEnabled $false -GroupIds AgencyUsers-NoDashboard@tenant.com
```

1.7 — Disable the Viva Insights web app for non-permitted users (now the primary access control)

The Viva Insights web app VFAM control disables the **entire** web app (Copilot Dashboard, Copilot Analytics reports, and advanced analysis and admin tools) for targeted users. Scope the disable policy to `AgencyUsers-NoDashboard`. This keeps the web app On for Central IT and agency analysts while blocking everyone else.

Important: the separate **Copilot Dashboard** VFAM control and its `-FeatureId CopilotDashboard` policy are **no longer available**. This web-app control is now the supported way to remove dashboard access, and there is no documented way to remove only the Copilot Dashboard while leaving the rest of the web app available. Policies previously created against the old control now apply to the entire web app, and the **Agent Dashboard** must be set separately (step 1.5). Any negative test recorded against the old control is no longer evidence; re-run it.

After Phase 1 — Verification:

1. Confirm no agency leaders appear in the dashboard access list.
2. Verify VFAM policies (AutoCxo, Delegation, AgentDashboard, MetricsExport, and the Viva Insights web app control) show as disabled for the `AgencyUsers-NoDashboard` group.
3. Have an agency CEO attempt to access `insights.cloud.microsoft` and confirm access is denied.
4. Have a non-agency executive (e.g., CFO) confirm they **still** have dashboard access.

2 Phase 2: Organizational Data

Prepare the foundational data that enables partitioning. Your approach depends on which path you chose in Section 4.1. For detailed refresh cadence tables, see Section 6: Organizational Data Strategy.

Path A: CSV Org Data Upload

- Create a consolidated CSV file containing ALL employees across ALL agencies.
- Include the critical custom attribute: **Agency** (e.g., "Agency A", "Agency B").
- Include required fields: **Microsoft_PersonEmail**, **Microsoft_ManagerEmail**, **Microsoft_Organization** (M365 Admin Center names) or **PersonId**, **ManagerId**, **Organization**, **EffectiveDate** (legacy Viva Insights names).
- Before upload, record attribute source/precedence and check **Setup → Migration and imports**, Message Center, and tenant UI. Use Organizational Data in Microsoft 365 for new/edited uploads unless the tenant explicitly presents a supported legacy path. Workday has a documented 100,000–user limit; API-based import remains preview and requires an environment check.

Path A Verification:

Check Viva Insights Admin → Data Quality to verify the **Agency** attribute has 100% coverage. Verify employee counts per agency match HR records.

Path B: Entra ID Domain (No CSV)

- **No CSV upload required.** The **Domain** attribute is system-generated from each employee's primary SMTP address.
- **Recommended:** Navigate to Viva Insights → Organizational data → **Configure Entra connection** → enable **ManagerId** and **Organization** checkboxes → **Save**. This enriches your data with manager hierarchy and department info (takes ~24 hours to sync).
- Verify domain mapping: confirm that each agency's employees use a distinct email domain (e.g., **agencya.gov.au**, **agencyb.gov.au**).

Path B Verification:

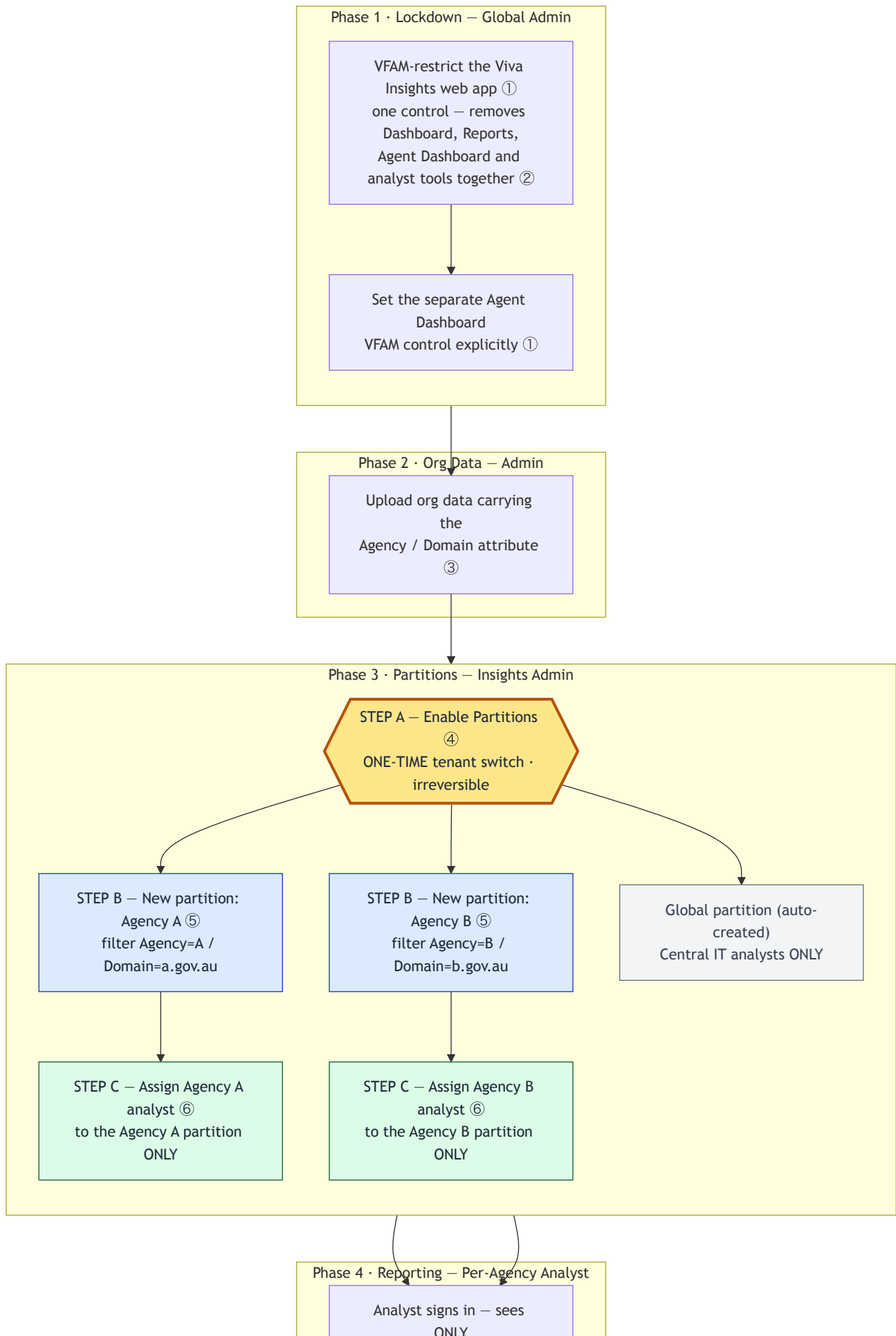
In Viva Insights Admin → Organizational data, verify that **Domain** appears as an available attribute. Check the Data Quality page to see Domain values and confirm they cleanly map to agencies. If any employees use a shared domain (e.g., contractors on **shared.gov.au**), decide how to handle them (see Shared Services Decision below).

Shared Services Decision (both paths): If your organisation has shared-services teams (IT, Legal, Finance) that serve multiple agencies, choose one of these approaches:

1. **Dedicated "Shared Services" partition** (recommended) — Create a separate partition filtered by `Agency = "Shared Services"` (Path A) or `Domain = "shared.gov.au"` (Path B). Central IT analysts access this partition alongside the global partition.
2. **Global partition query path** — Exclude shared services from agency partitions. Approved global analysts can query them; Dashboard, Agent, export, manager, and Power BI visibility remains separately governed.
3. **Include in every agency partition** — Not recommended. Creates duplicate data and inflates agency metrics.

3 Phase 3: Partitions Setup

Create the row/column controls for each agency analyst query workspace. The partition filter differs by path, but all other steps are identical. These controls do not scope the other surfaces in the boundary matrix.



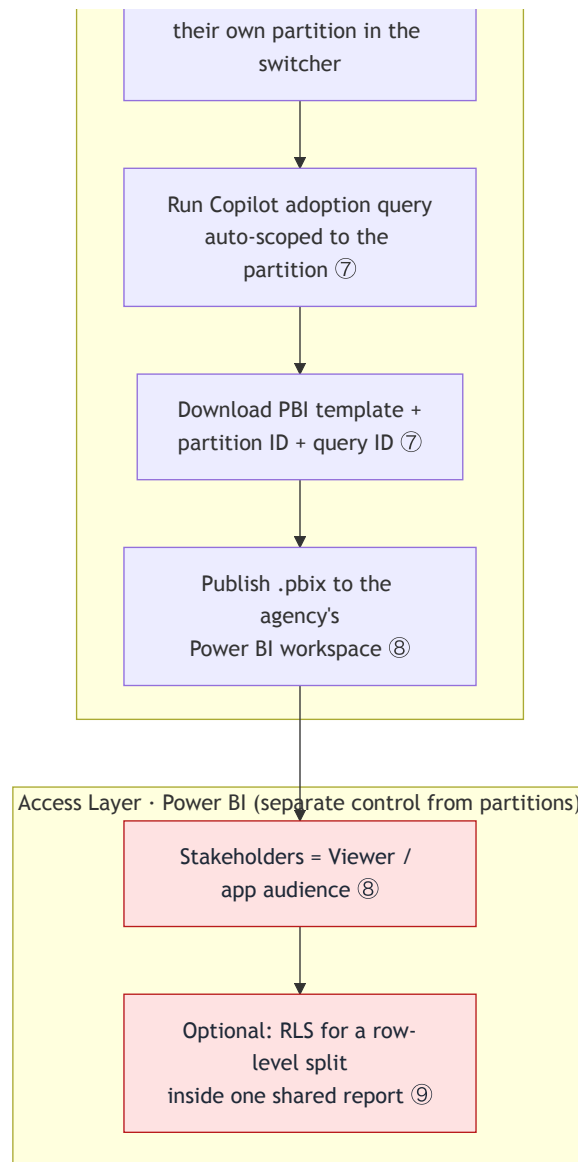


Figure 1 — Where partition enabling fits. Phase 3 has two actions that are easy to conflate: **Enable Partitions** (④) is a one-time tenant-wide switch, while **New partition** (⑤) is repeated per agency. Assigning each analyst to the intended partition only (⑥) is required for that analyst query workspace to remain scoped. It does not govern the other surfaces in this pattern. Each numbered step links to its Microsoft Learn reference:

1. ① VFAM lockdown — restrict the **Viva Insights web app** (one control, which removes the Copilot Dashboard, Copilot Analytics reports, and advanced analysis and admin tools together), then set the separate **Agent Dashboard** control explicitly — Viva feature access management
2. ② What gets locked down (the tenant-wide view) — Connect to the Copilot Dashboard
3. ③ Upload org data carrying the Agency / Domain attribute — Organizational data in Microsoft 365
4. ④ **Enable Partitions** — the one-time tenant switch — Customize privacy settings → Partitions
5. ⑤ **Create one partition per agency** and set its filter — Partitions in Viva Insights
6. ⑥ Assign the Insights Analyst to their partition **only** — Assign user roles
7. ⑦ Run the Copilot query & download the Power BI template (partition + query IDs) — Microsoft 365 Copilot adoption report
8. ⑧ Distribute via a Power BI workspace/app to a Viewer audience — Roles in workspaces · Publish an app

9. ⑨ Optional row-level split inside one shared report — Row-level security (RLS)

The Power BI access layer (⑧–⑨) is a *separate* control from partitions: partitions decide what data the analyst can query; Power BI workspace/app permissions and RLS decide who can open the published report and which rows they see.

Before Enabling Partitions — Confirm:

- (a) **Path A:** You have a reliable, repeatable process for monthly org data uploads with the Agency attribute.
- Path B:** You have verified Domain values cleanly map to agencies.
- (b) You have identified at least one Insights Analyst per agency.
- (c) You accept that turning partitions off requires Microsoft Support. Confirm current deletion impact with Support and export partition configuration, query results, custom metrics, and report dependencies before change.
- (d) You understand that privacy settings (minimum group size) are tenant-wide, not per-partition — all agencies must agree on the number.
- (e) **Export all existing Viva Insights reports and query results** and capture the full pre-change state before enabling partitions. A rollback depends on Support and restoration of separately captured policies, assignments, organizational data, and Power BI permissions.

- Navigate to `insights.cloud.microsoft` → **Admin** → **Privacy settings** → **Partitions**. Select **Enable Partitions**.
- Select **New partition**. Name it (e.g., “Agency A”).
 - **Path A filter:** Set `Agency = "Agency A"`
 - **Path B filter:** Set `Domain = "agencya.gov.au"`

Verify the **Filtered employees** counter matches the expected headcount for that agency. Select **Save**.

- Click the newly created partition → **Edit** → **Analysts** tab → **Add analysts**. Search for the designated agency analyst by name or email → select → **Save**. Assign agency analysts to their respective agency partitions **only**. Do NOT assign agency analysts to the global partition.
- Assign Central IT analysts to the automatically created **Global Partition** for tenant-wide queries.
- Repeat for each agency. Allow 1–2 hours for partition access to propagate.

Why agency analysts must not have unapproved global partition access: A global-partition analyst can run tenant-wide queries and may receive broader Viva Insights access. Treat this as an explicit privileged assignment, not an agency role. Remove accidental access immediately; for an approved Central IT analyst, record business purpose, conflict-of-interest review, expiry, and quarterly recertification.

After Phase 3 — Verification:

Have each agency analyst sign in to `insights.cloud.microsoft`. Confirm the partition switcher and a

test person query match the approved agency population. Then execute the complete actor/surface negative-test matrix; a passing query count alone is not sufficient for release.

Analyst Onboarding Checklist — First Day in a Partition

Share these steps with each agency analyst after they receive partition access:

1. Sign in to `insights.cloud.microsoft` with your analyst account.
2. Look for the **partition switcher** in the top bar. Select your agency's partition (e.g., "Agency A").
3. In the left nav, select **Create analysis**. You should see Power BI templates (Copilot Adoption, Impact Explorer, Business Impact, etc.) and the custom person query option.
4. Run a **test Person Query**: select a few basic Copilot metrics, set a 28-day window, and run. Verify the employee count in the results matches your agency's expected headcount.
5. Verify you **cannot** see: the Copilot Dashboard in the left nav, any Admin panel, or any partition other than your own in the switcher.
6. Check **Analysis results** — the expected result is queries associated with the selected partition and no unapproved cross-agency result. Capture the observation and escalate any mismatch.

If anything doesn't match, contact your Insights Admin to verify partition assignment and role configuration.

4 Phase 4: Copilot Reporting

Generate partition-scoped query outputs and distribute reports through a separately governed Power BI or approved manager-reporting path.

4a — What Copilot Analytics Are Available in a Partition?

Not all Copilot analytics surfaces are partition-scoped. Use this matrix to set expectations with agency stakeholders:

Analytics Surface	Available in Agency Partition
Custom Person Queries (Copilot metrics)	YES — partition-scoped
Power BI Templates (Copilot Adoption, Impact Explorer, Business Impact, Headlines, etc.)	YES — query starts in partition
Custom Metrics & Metric Rules	YES — created in the partition
Analysis Results	YES — associated with partition
Copilot Dashboard	NO — not partition-scoped
Copilot Analytics Reports (OOB reports)	NO — not governed by partition
Agent Dashboard	NO — preview and not partition-scoped
Readiness / licence reporting	NO — not partition-scoped
Sentiment (Viva Glint / CSV survey)	NO — tenant-level or global
Satisfaction Rate (thumbs up/down)	NO — tenant-level or global

Key takeaway: An agency partition scopes rows and columns in the analyst query workspace. Direct Dashboard, OOB Reports, Agent, export, delegation, manager, global, downloaded-result, and Power BI access are separately governed and must be independently tested.

4b — Deliver Reports to Agency Heads

- Agency analysts run Copilot Power BI template queries within their assigned partition and validate the result population before publication.

Option A: Power BI Workspaces (requires Power BI Pro/Premium licences for viewers)

- Create dedicated Power BI workspaces per agency (e.g., **Agency-A-Copilot-Analytics**).

- Publish reports and grant Viewer access to agency leadership via Entra group.
- Configure Row-Level Security (RLS) as a secondary control if multiple agencies share a workspace.
- **Licensing:** Each viewer needs a **Power BI Pro** or **Premium Per User (PPU)** licence. Alternatively, if your organisation has a **Power BI Premium capacity** (P or F SKU), reports published to that capacity can be viewed by users with a free Power BI licence — eliminating per-user viewer costs. Consult your licensing/finance owner.

Option B: Viva Insights Publish Reports (prerequisites apply — review notes below)

- Use the **Publish Reports** feature in the Viva Insights analyst experience.
- **“Filter report by manager hierarchy”:** Publishes to enabled managers. The intended report follows the recipient’s hierarchy, but shared executives, cross-agency managers, source errors, and other access paths require direct testing before release.
- **“Unfiltered original report”:** Publishes to users who have been granted **Copilot Dashboard access**. In the multi-agency lockdown, dashboard access is restricted to Central IT — so this sub-option does **not** reach agency heads.
- Recipients view published reports in the Viva Insights web app → Reports tab.
- Set expiry date (up to 365 days) and republish as needed.

⚠ Publish Reports Risk in Multi-Agency:

Manager enablement and hierarchy can introduce additional Dashboard/reporting access, especially for shared executives and cross-agency managers. Before using “Filter by manager hierarchy,” run the full surface matrix with a pilot leader and delegate. If any broader access appears, or a required negative test cannot be executed, the publication veto applies: disable the pilot manager path and use **Option A (Power BI workspaces/apps)** after separately testing its permissions.

Recommendation: Use Option A as the primary delivery surface for agency heads. Reserve Publish Reports for Central IT analysts who already have dashboard access.

⚠ Licensing Prerequisite for Publish Reports Recipients:

To view published reports, recipients must have a **Viva Insights service plan**. This is automatically included with every M365 Copilot licence. However, if an agency head does **not** have a Copilot licence, they will need a **standalone Viva Insights licence** to access published reports in the web app. Confirm licensing coverage before choosing this delivery path.

Publish Reports Pilot Procedure (recommended before full rollout):

1. Select **one pilot agency CEO** who has a Copilot licence (Viva Insights service plan included).
2. In Manager Settings, enable this CEO as a manager (ensure their team meets minimum team size).

3. Wait 1 hour for manager settings to propagate.
4. Have the pilot CEO navigate to `insights.cloud.microsoft`. Check whether they can see the **Copilot Dashboard** in the left nav and whether it shows “Your company” data across all agencies.
5. **If any unapproved broader access appears:** Disable the pilot CEO’s manager access, preserve evidence, and fall back to a separately tested Power BI workspace/app.
6. **If all required tests pass:** obtain the required owner and Compliance/Privacy/DPO sign-off before expanding.
7. After pilot, publish a test report, run every relevant negative test, and add the complete evidence record to the release pack.

After Phase 4 — Verification:

Have an agency CEO view their report (either PBI or Viva Insights). Confirm: (a) only their agency’s employees appear, (b) no cross-agency group names or data are visible, (c) the minimum group size threshold is respected for small departments within the agency.

6. Organizational Data Strategy

How employee data reaches Viva Insights depends on the chosen path and current tenant migration state. Before every change, record attribute-level source and precedence, inspect Data Quality and Profile, check **Setup → Migration and imports** plus Message Center, and use the path actually supported in the tenant. Do not infer that one upload universally replaces Entra.

6.1 Path A: CSV Org Data Upload

Data Type	Source
Employee hierarchy (ManagerId)	Centralized HR or per-agency HR feeds (CSV), HRIS connector, or API-based
Custom attributes (Agency, FunctionType)	HR system (via CSV, HRIS connector, or API)
Copilot usage data	Automatic from M365 signals

Data Quality Rule: The `Agency` attribute must have 100% coverage. Missing values will exclude employees from all partitions.

Data Ownership Model for Multi-Agency CSV Management

1. **Designate one Central IT owner** responsible for the consolidated CSV file across all agencies.
2. **Establish a monthly collection process:** Each agency HR team exports their employee data extract → Central IT merges all extracts into a single CSV with the **Agency** attribute populated for every row.
3. **Validate before upload:** Check that every row has a non-empty **Agency** value, that employee counts per agency match HR records, and that the **PersonId** (email) format is correct.
4. **Upload and verify:** Use Organizational Data in Microsoft 365 for new/edited uploads unless the tenant explicitly presents a supported legacy path. After processing, verify source ownership and **Agency** coverage in Data Quality/Profile before refreshing any partition output.
5. **Automate only when supported:** API-based import is preview; Workday has a 100,000–user limit; API/Azure paths and other administrator features vary by cloud. Validate the dated supported–environments matrix, Workday article, API preview article, and tenant UI before design.

Data Refresh Failure Alerting (Path A):

If a monthly org data upload fails or the Agency attribute is missing for new employees, those employees silently disappear from all partitions. Nobody gets alerted.

Mitigations:

- After each upload, check the **Data Quality** page in Viva Insights Admin to verify attribute coverage.
- Set a calendar reminder to verify Agency attribute has 100% coverage within 7 days of each upload.
- Where the exact cloud and tenant support it, evaluate API-based import (preview) or another documented connector. Preserve a manual rollback and validation path.

6.2 Path B: Entra ID Domain (No CSV)

Data Type	Source	Refresh Caden
Domain (agency identifier)	Primary SMTP address (system-generated)	Automatic — u
Employee hierarchy (ManagerId)	Entra ID (enable via Configure Entra connection)	Automatic — ~
Department (Organization)	Entra ID Department field (enable via Configure Entra connection)	Automatic — ~
Copilot usage data	Automatic from M365 signals	Daily (6-day d

Key advantage: No ongoing data maintenance. New employees automatically appear in the correct partition based on their SMTP domain. Departing employees are automatically removed when their account is disabled.

Path B Limitation: You cannot filter by custom attributes (Cost Centre, Job Function, Location, etc.) within agency partitions. If you need these filters, upload a CSV using the parallel data ingestion method — Entra continues providing ManagerId and Organization while the CSV adds custom attributes.

6.3 Upgrading from Path B to Path A

Organisations can start with Path B for rapid deployment and later add a CSV upload to unlock richer analytics:

- 1. Enable **parallel data ingestion** in Viva Insights → Organizational data → Configure Entra connection.
- 2. Keep Entra as the source for **ManagerId** and **Organization** .
- 3. Upload a CSV with additional attributes (**Agency** , **FunctionType** , **Location** , etc.).
- 4. Update partition filters from **Domain** to **Agency** if preferred (edit each partition → change filter condition).

7. Access Control Matrix

Role	Copilot Dashboard	Partition Access
Global Administrator	Tenant-wide Dashboard access	No query access u
Insights Administrator	Not granted by this role alone	Can manage parti
AI Administrator	Must add or otherwise qualify itself; role alone is not a view grant	None unless an Ins
Insights Analyst (Agency A)	Expected denied unless another access source exists; test directly	Agency A query w
Agency A CEO / VP	✗ Not enabled	✗ No direct acce

Role & Partition Interaction Scenarios

In a multi-agency environment, the combination of **roles** and **partition assignments** determines what each user can actually do. This is the most common source of confusion during implementation.

Scenario	Roles Assigned	Partition Assignment
Central IT Admin (configure only)	Insights Admin	None needed
Central IT Admin + Analyst	Insights Admin + Insights Analyst	Global partition
Agency A Analyst	Insights Analyst	Agency A partition
Agency A Analyst mistakenly on Global partition	Insights Analyst	Global + Agency A
AI Admin managing VFAM	AI Admin	N/A
Broad Central IT role combination	AI Admin + Insights Admin + Insights Analyst	Global partition

Critical Rule: Do not assign an agency analyst to the **Global partition**. It enables tenant-wide queries and may introduce broader Viva Insights access. Reserve it for approved Central IT analysts with least-privilege justification, conflict-of-interest review, expiry, evidence, and quarterly recertification. Verify assignments after every analyst change and run the full surface test.

8. Governance & Ongoing Operations

- **Monthly (Path A):** Refresh organizational data through the supported path and verify source, precedence, coverage, and partition counts. **Path B:** no CSV refresh, but verify domain mapping, exceptions, transfers, and shared-service identities.
- **Monthly:** Refresh Copilot PBI template queries and publish reports (Agency Analysts).
- **Quarterly:** Re-run every actor/surface negative test; recertify global and multi-partition access, shared executives, cross-agency managers, delegates, conflicts of interest, Power BI roles, and export/resharing settings; retain the evidence pack.
- **Onboarding:** To add a new agency: **Path A** — add them to the CSV, create a new partition, assign an analyst. **Path B** — create a partition filtered by the new agency's domain, assign an analyst. Both paths: spin up a new PBI workspace or use Publish Reports.
- **Every material change:** follow change control, capture the pre-change state, pilot, retest, obtain approvals, and veto continued publication on failure.

Day 2 Operations Runbook

Scenario	Who	Action
Employee transfers from Agency A to Agency B	Central IT	Path A: Update Agency attribute in the Path B: Change the employee's primary
New agency created	Central IT + Insights Admin	Path A: Add agency to CSV → create pa Path B: Create partition filtered by new a Both: create PBI workspace or use Publis
Agency merged or retired	Insights Admin	Update Agency attribute for merged e
Agency analyst leaves	Insights Admin	Remove from partition → assign replace
AutoCxo accidentally re-enabled	Central IT	Verify in Microsoft 365 admin center →
New hire not appearing in any partition	Central IT	Path A: Check if the employee has the Path B: Verify the employee's primary S

9. Risk Register

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Auto-enablement policy is accidentally re-enabled	High	Document the policy; set
Partition filter misconfigured, includes wrong agency	High	Validate filtered employee
Power BI workspace permissions grant cross-agency access	High	Use dedicated workspace
Copilot Metrics Export enabled — user-level data downloadable	High	Disable CopilotMetrics
Agent Dashboard exposes cross-agency agent usage	Medium	Where the preview exists,
Analytics Reports auto-available to global partition analysts	High	Ensure agency analysts ar
Org data upload fails — employees silently drop from partitions	Medium	Verify attribute source, pr
Analyst query results not transferable when analyst leaves	Low	Document this limitation.
Shared executive or cross-agency manager receives a scope spanning agencies	High	Model the hierarchy explic
Global or multi-partition analyst has a conflict of interest	High	Separate duties where po
Preview or cloud capability changes after go-live	High	Monitor Learn, Message C

10. Discovery Questions for Customer

1. **Is the requirement reporting segmentation or a tenant/cryptographic/sovereign/certified security boundary?** This pattern addresses only the former. Escalate the latter to Security architecture, Compliance/Privacy/DPO, and Microsoft Support.
2. **Does each agency have a distinct email domain, or do all agencies share one domain?** This determines the candidate analyst–partition attribute, not an end–to–end boundary. See Section 4.1.
3. **How is the Entra ID ManagerID hierarchy currently structured?** (Determines if CEOs are auto–identified as senior leaders).
4. **How many total employees per agency, and how many have Copilot licenses?** (Partitions need sufficient population to meet the minimum group size threshold, default 10).
5. **Are there shared–services teams (IT, Legal, Finance) that serve multiple agencies?** (Determines if a "Shared Services" partition is needed).
6. **What minimum privacy threshold (minimum group size) is acceptable?** (This is set tenant–wide; all agencies must agree on the number).
7. **Do agency leaders need Power BI Pro/Premium licences, or should we use Viva Insights Publish Reports?** (Determines report distribution method — Phase 4 options.)
8. **Has anyone already been granted Copilot Dashboard access or does any analyst have global partition access?** (Must audit and remediate before proceeding with Phase 1 lockdown.)
9. **Is there an automated HR data feed, or will org data uploads be manual CSV?** (Impacts reliability of partition boundaries over time.)
10. **Are Copilot agents deployed across agencies?** Agent Dashboard is preview, separately governed, unavailable in national/regional clouds, and not partition–scoped. Validate whether it exists and restrict/test it independently.
11. **Which shared executives, cross–agency managers, global users, global/multi–partition analysts, and conflicts of interest exist?** Document expected visibility and test every surface.
12. **What exact cloud and organizational–data migration state applies?** Validate Agent/export/Copilot Power BI/API availability and attribute precedence before design.

Appendix A: PowerShell Reference

Note: Most VFAM policies listed below can also be configured via the Admin UI: admin.microsoft.com → Settings → Microsoft Viva → Viva Insights → Turn Advanced Insights on or off. **Use the Admin UI for one–off changes.** Use PowerShell for scripted deployments, bulk operations, or when the Admin UI does not expose the control (e.g., CopilotMetricsReport).

```
# Install required module
Install-Module -Name ExchangeOnlineManagement -Force -AllowClobber
```

```

Connect-ExchangeOnline -UserPrincipalName admin@tenant.com

# Disable Auto-Enablement for the agency-user group
Add-VivaModuleFeaturePolicy `
  -ModuleId VivaInsights `
  -FeatureId AutoCxoIdentification `
  -Name "DisableAutoEnableForAgencyUsers" `
  -IsFeatureEnabled $false `
  -GroupIds "group-object-id"

# Disable Delegation for the agency-user group
Add-VivaModuleFeaturePolicy `
  -ModuleId VivaInsights `
  -FeatureId CopilotDashboardDelegation `
  -Name "DisableDelegationForAgencyUsers" `
  -IsFeatureEnabled $false `
  -GroupIds "group-object-id"

# Disable Agent Dashboard for the agency-user group where the preview exists
Add-VivaModuleFeaturePolicy `
  -ModuleId VivaInsights `
  -FeatureId AgentDashboard `
  -Name "DisableAgentDashboardForAgencyUsers" `
  -IsFeatureEnabled $false `
  -GroupIds "group-object-id"

# Disable preview Copilot Metrics Export for the agency-user group
Add-VivaModuleFeaturePolicy `
  -ModuleId VivaInsights `
  -FeatureId CopilotMetricsReport `
  -Name "DisableMetricsExportForAgencyUsers" `
  -IsFeatureEnabled $false `
  -GroupIds "group-object-id"

# Audit current policies
Get-VivaModuleFeaturePolicy -ModuleId VivaInsights

```

Appendix B: Organizational Data CSV Template

Example data shape. Confirm the current tenant-supported import surface, required column names, attribute precedence, and validation rules before use:

```

EffectiveDate,PersonId,ManagerId,Organization,Agency,FunctionType,LevelDesignation
2026-02-01,user1@tenant.com,ceo-a@tenant.com,Engineering,Agency A,Engineering,Director
2026-02-01,user2@tenant.com,user1@tenant.com,Engineering,Agency A,Engineering,Manager
2026-02-01,ceo-a@tenant.com,,Executive,Agency A,Executive,CEO
2026-02-01,user4@tenant.com,ceo-b@tenant.com,Operations,Agency B,Operations,Director
2026-02-01,ceo-b@tenant.com,,Executive,Agency B,Executive,CEO

```